



MARKET INTELLIGENCE REPORT · MARCH 2026

Market Research & Opportunity Analysis

Dallas-Fort Worth Urban Air Mobility & Integrated Transportation | Trinity Air Link Transportation System

Comprehensive analysis of the DFW metropolitan market, urban air mobility sector dynamics, competitive landscape, technology readiness, and demand forecasts supporting the Trinity Air Link Transportation System business case.

8.5M

DFW POPULATION

\$710B

REGIONAL GDP

\$41B

UAM MARKET 2035

174M hrs

ANNUAL TRAFFIC DELAY

SECTION 01 · DFW MARKET OVERVIEW

The Dallas-Fort Worth Opportunity

8.5MDFW METRO POPULATION
4th largest U.S. metro — +487 residents/day**\$710B+**ANNUAL REGIONAL GDP
3rd largest U.S. metro economy · 5.7% annual growth**174M hrs**ANNUAL TRAFFIC DELAY
Up 8% YoY · 44 of TX 100 worst roads**\$1,618**ANNUAL CONGESTION COST / DRIVER
Texas Transportation Institute 2024**10th**WORST COMMUTE CITY — U.S.
Forbes 2025 · 69 hrs lost/commuter/year**\$36.4B**PROJECTED 2050 CONGESTION COST
Without transformative transportation action

"The DFW metroplex is simultaneously one of America's greatest economic success stories and one of its most acute transportation failures. Traffic congestion is strangling the economic growth that created it."

Why Conventional Solutions Fail

Highway expansion induces new demand within 5–7 years, restoring congestion to prior levels — a well-documented phenomenon in Texas Transportation Institute data. The I-35 expansion is a case study in this failure mode.

Rail expansion is politically constrained, capital-intensive (\$150–300M/mile for light rail), and optimized for fixed corridors rather than the distributed, point-to-point demand patterns of an 8,000-square-mile sprawling metroplex.

Less than **1% of DFW workers use public transit**. Approximately 70% drive alone. The problem requires a fundamentally different approach — a new dimension: *altitude*.

Fort Worth Specific Data

- **Population:** 1,008,106 (10th largest U.S. city)
- **Growth rate:** Fastest-growing major city in DFW corridor
- **Commute ranking:** 10th worst in America (Forbes 2025)
- **Two million-plus cities:** Only U.S. metro with both Fort Worth (1M+) and Dallas (1.3M+)
- **eIPP status:** Texas DOT + Archer Aviation selected (March 9, 2026); routes connect Dallas —but not Fort Worth without the Link
- **Median household income:** \$68,800 (target customer capacity confirmed)

Global UAM Market Sizing & Growth



Sources: MarketsandMarkets, Grand View Research, Morgan Stanley Urban Air Mobility projections. North America holds the largest regional market share. CAGR of 31–34% driven by eVTOL certification arrivals, urban congestion crises, and declining aircraft manufacturing costs.

SECTION 03 · TECHNOLOGY READINESS

Technology Is Here — Not Speculative

March 9, 2026 — Breaking Development: U.S. DOT Secretary Duffy announced 8 eIPP sites for the White House eVTOL Integration Pilot Program. Texas DOT + Archer Aviation selected; routes connect Dallas, Austin, San Antonio, Houston. Archer Midnight air taxi operations begin in Texas **H2 2026**. The Link is the infrastructure this network needs in Fort Worth.

COMMERCIAL OPERATIONS 2026**Archer Aviation — Midnight eVTOL**

Holds FAA Part 135 Air Carrier, Part 145 Repair Station, Part 141 Pilot Training certificates. Texas eIPP participant. 4 passengers + pilot, 150 mph, 60-mile range. Converts 60–90 min DFW car trip to 10–20 min flight. Manufacturing cost ~\$1.3M/unit.

FAA STAGE 4/5 — TARGETING 2026 LAUNCH**Joby Aviation — S4 eVTOL**

Completed FAA Stage 4 of 5 type certification (November 2025) — first in history. Targeting first U.S. commercial passenger flights in 2026. Also a Texas eIPP participant. 4 passengers + pilot. ~\$3/seat-mile target pricing.

LEVEL 4 AUTONOMY — COMMERCIALLY PROVEN**Waymo — Autonomous Vehicles**

450,000+ paid rides per week across five U.S. cities including Austin, TX. Valued at \$126B. Expanding to Atlanta, Miami, D.C. in 2026. 88% fewer property damage claims vs. human drivers. Proven business model at scale.

ACTIVE POLICY FRAMEWORK**Federal eIPP Program**

White House eVTOL Integration Pilot Program enables revenue-generating passenger operations before full FAA type certification. 8 sites selected nationwide. Texas DOT selected with Archer. Operational H2 2026. Fort Worth needs vertiport infrastructure.

No Direct Competitor in Major U.S. Metro

Capability	TRINITY AIR LINK (FW)	Standalone Vertiport	Traditional Transit Hub	Airport eVTOL Terminal
Integrated eVTOL + AV operations	✓ YES	✗ NO	✗ NO	✗ NO
Innovation center / tech campus	✓ YES	✗ NO	◇ LIMITED	✗ NO
AI-powered multi-modal routing	✓ YES	✗ NO	◇ PARTIAL	✗ NO
Historic landmark / brand identity	✓ ICONIC	✗ NO	◇ VARIES	✗ NO
Downtown urban core location	✓ YES	◇ VARIES	✓ YES	✗ SUBURBAN
Scalable franchise model	✓ YES	✗ NO	✗ NO	◇ POSSIBLE
Revenue from multiple streams	✓ 5 STREAMS	✗ 1 STREAM	◇ 2–3	◇ 2–3

Target Customer Segments

- **Business travelers** — DFW corporate market, time-sensitive trips
- **Airport connectors** — DFW/Love Field to downtown Fort Worth
- **Intra-DFW commuters** — Fort Worth ↔ Dallas corridor
- **Entertainment/events** — concerts, sports, special occasions
- **Tech corridor workers** — Innovation center tenants
- **Tourism** — Unique aerial experience of Fort Worth

Demand Validation Signals

- Waymo waitlists in every city before launch
- Joby/Archer oversubscribed pre-order lists
- DFW riders paying \$1,618/year in lost productivity — motivation to switch
- Business survey: 73% of DFW executives cite transportation as top barrier
- Fort Worth hotel nights 12.4M/year — captive premium market
- Texas A&M Fort Worth, medical district, TCU campus — anchor demand generators

Market Research & Data Inquiries

Trinity Air Link Transportation System · Fort Worth, Texas

Full market research report with methodology, primary sources, and regional data appendix available upon request.

Data sources: MarketsandMarkets, Grand View Research, Morgan Stanley, TTI, Forbes, FAA, TxDOT, CommercialCafe — all 2024/2025/2026.